

Jacob Hazen

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics 2022 – Expected April 2027

McGill University

Advisors: Prof. Fabian Lange and Prof. Fernando Saltiel

M.A. in Economics, Specialization in Data Science (Thesis) 2020 – 2022

Carleton University

Advisor: Prof. Ba Chu

B.A. in Economics, Minor in Computer Science 2016 – 2020

University of Calgary

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Primary: Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Secondary: Applied Econometrics, Economics of Education

JOB MARKET PAPER

“It’s More Than Time and Money: How the Parent-Child Relationship Shapes Skill Formation”

Abstract: I study how the parent-child relationship shapes the development of children’s socio-emotional skills. I develop and estimate a dynamic model of household decision-making in which parents allocate time across work, leisure, and active time with the child, and choose how much to spend on the child. These choices build a parent-child bond, which captures emotional warmth and consistency. Investment affects skills mainly through the bond: it builds the bond, which in turn builds skills, while its direct effect on skills is small. I also find that mothers’ active time is the most productive input into investment, followed by fathers’ active time and then expenditures on the child. Counterfactual analysis shows that policies raising family income have little effect on parental investment, although they raise the bond more than they raise skills. Policies that could change how parents value the child’s skills or the relationship, or that directly strengthen the bond, such as school-based or family therapy programs, are more effective at raising socio-emotional skills. These findings place the parent-child bond, rather than investment itself, at the centre of the technology of socio-emotional skill formation.

WORKING PAPERS

“Human Capital Development of Socio-Emotional Skills in Children”

Best Third-Year Research Paper Award; CRDCN Award & Webinar; SSHRC Doctoral Award

“Persistent Inequality in Maternal Mental Health”

With Fernando Saltiel

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Parenting Style and Multidimensional Skills”

With Kentaro Asai

REPORTS

“Did the Pandemic and Current Labour Shortages Change the Quality of Jobs?” 2024

With Mahmut Ablay, Luc Bissonnette, and Fabian Lange

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

McGill University 2023

Research Assistant; Prof. Fabian Lange

Queen’s & Carleton University 2022

Research Assistant; Prof. James MacKinnon, Prof. Matt Webb, Prof. Morten Ørregaard Nielsen

Carleton University 2022

Research Assistant (Computer Science); APEX Group

University of Calgary (PatiML) 2020

Research Assistant; Prof. Alexander Whalley

WORK EXPERIENCE

McGill University & Carleton University 2020 – Present

Teaching Assistant

Graduate: Graduate Economic Data Science, Graduate Macroeconomics

Undergraduate: Applied Data Analysis, Introductory Econometrics, Introductory Microeconomics, Introductory Macroeconomics, Economic Statistics, Game Theory

Junior Data Science Analyst 2021–2022

Infrastructure Canada

Data Analyst, Data Science (Internship) 2021

Infrastructure Canada

Data Scientist (Internship) 2020

Critical Mass

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Royal Economic Society Conference (2026); Canadian Economics Association 60th Annual Conference (2026); 20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students’ Conference (2026); CRDCN Emerging Scholars Webinar (2025); Canadian Economics Association 59th Annual Conference (2025); “Artificial Intelligence in Economics,” Expanding Economics & McGill AI Society (2024)

SERVICE

President, McGill Economics Graduate Society (2024–present); Ph.D. Representative, CIREQ (2024–present); Co-President, Carleton Graduate Economics Society (2021–2022); Varsity Athlete, University of Calgary (2016–2018)

HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

CRDCN Emerging Scholar Award (\$1,200)	2025
Best Third-Year Research Paper Award, McGill University	2025
SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship (\$80,000)	2025
Graduate Excellence Award in Economics (5-year Ph.D. funding)	2022
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (Declined, \$15,000)	2022
Randall Geehan Memorial Scholarship in Quantitative Economics (\$1,200)	2022
Departmental Merit Scholarship, Carleton University	2020
Dean's List, University of Calgary	2020
University of Calgary Faculty of Science IDEAS Fund Award	2020
Jason Lang Scholarship, University of Calgary	2019
Alexander Rutherford Scholarship, Government of Alberta	2016

REFERENCES

Placement Directors

Prof. Rui Castro

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Prof. Kensuke Sakamoto

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Reference Letters

Prof. Fabian Lange

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Prof. Fernando Saltiel

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Prof. Nicolas Gendron-Carrier

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PROGRAMMING SKILLS

Python, R, Stata, SQL, Bash/Unix/Linux, Git, Matlab, Julia; Docker, PostGIS/RDBMS, LaTeX

LANGUAGES

English (Native), French (Intermediate)